

Reading it Right

BJP's prime ministerial candidate L.K. Advani loves to read. He has just finished *1000 Years, 1000 People: Ranking the Men and Women Who Shaped the Millennium*. The book has ranked Johannes Gutenberg, inventor of the printing press as No. 1 among the 1,000. "Even before Mahatma Gandhi and Christopher Columbus," Advani says with a smile. Obviously, election eve is a good time to appreciate the power of the press. It will come

HK RAMSHEKAR

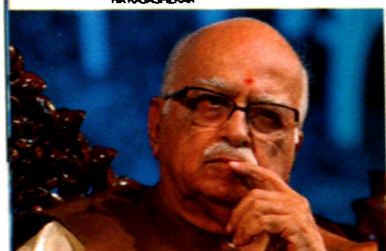


MANMOHAN SINGH WILL MEET GORDON BROWN IN LONDON DURING THE G-20 MEET

DELHI | Fit for London

Prime Minister Manmohan Singh is preparing himself for some wall-to-wall diplomacy on his forthcoming trip to London. On April 2, he will be meeting a cross-section of world leaders at the G-20 Summit on the global economic crisis, the group's second such meet. British Premier Gordon Brown was keen that Manmohan should be present at the meeting. It is expected the London Summit will help find a way to combat the economic meltdown. Along with economic affairs, political diplomacy is also on the menu for the prime minister. He will be meeting US President Barack Obama on April 2 and a discussion on the situation in South Asia in the aftermath of the 26/11 Mumbai attacks is expected. The summit will also allow Manmohan to make his farewell calls to world leaders before the general elections scheduled for next month. After his heart surgery, Manmohan has kept his public engagements to a bare minimum. The prime minister's doctors are still debating if he's fit to take the eight-hour flight but an advance security liaison team is in London to make necessary arrangements for the visit. All fingers are crossed.

by Saurabh Shukla



Advani

as no surprise though that Advani's latest acquisition is an e-book: Barack Obama's *The Audacity of Hope*. With the IPL around the corner, Advani maintains that it is his son Jayant who keeps him updated on cricket. "My son inherited my love of cricket while my daughter inherited my love for movies," he says. In about two months, the country will be asking Advani his score. **by Priya Sahgal**

80

per cent of world trade will be represented by the G-20 leaders at the London Summit from April 2.